
MERYL YE

merylye@cmu.edu • merylye.github.io

Research Areas: Human-AI Interaction, Social and Behavioral Impacts of AI, AI Evaluation and Safety, Computational Social Science

Research Methods: Experimental Methods, Qualitative Methods, Participatory Research, Computational Text Analysis

Education

Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA Aug. 2024 – Present
Ph.D., Societal Computing, *Advisors: Steve Rathje, Bob Kraut*

Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA Aug. 2024 – May 2026
M.S., Societal Computing

Cornell University, Ithaca, NY Aug. 2020 – Dec. 2023
B.S., Computer Science with Honors, *magna cum laude*

Research Positions

Data & Society, AI On the Ground Oct. 2025 – Present
Research Assistant advised by Briana Vecchione, Livia Garofalo, Ranjit Singh

Carnegie Mellon University, Human-Computer Interaction Institute (HCII) Aug. 2025 – Present
Graduate Research Assistant advised by Steve Rathje, Bob Kraut

Carnegie Mellon University, Software and Societal Systems Department (S3D) Aug. 2024 – Aug. 2025
Graduate Research Assistant advised by Patrick Park

Cornell University, Department of Computer Science Aug. 2023 – Feb. 2024
Undergraduate Research Assistant advised by Jon Kleinberg

Cornell University, Department of Information Science June 2021 – Dec. 2023
Undergraduate Research Assistant advised by Malte Jung

Papers

M. Ye, R. Kraut, and S. Rathje. 2026. *Individual-level interventions against sycophantic AI reduce its appeal but not its persuasiveness*. (2026). <https://arxiv.org/abs/2607.25166>

M. Ye, L. Ibrahim, J. Y. Bo, M. Cheng, I. Mattsson, D. Vennemeyer, R. Kraut, and S. Rathje. 2026. *What Counts as AI Sycophancy? A Taxonomy and Expert Survey of a Fragmented Construct*. (2026). <https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.21778>

B. Vecchione, M. Ye, L. Garofalo, and R. Singh. 2026. *Engagement-Optimized Care: When LLMs become Mental Health Infrastructure*. To appear at AIES '26. (2026). <https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.23787>

D. Vennemeyer, P. A. Duong, M. Ye, R. Huang, and T. Jiang. 2026. *Sycophantic Praise: Evaluating Excessive Praise in Language Models*. To appear at EMNLP '26'. (2026). <https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.07441>

M. Ye and P. Park. 2025. "Network Structure, Addressivity, and Civility in Networked Publics." OSF Preprint. (2025). https://osf.io/preprints/socarxiv/un6ev_v1

I. Krsek, M. Ye, W. Xu, A. Ritter, L. Dabbish, and S. Das. 2026. "Supporting Informed Self-Disclosure: Design Recommendations for Presenting AI-Estimates of Privacy Risks to Users." In: *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (CHI '26). Association for Computing Machinery. ISBN: 9798400722783. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3790472>

S. Rathje, M. Ye, L. K. Globig, R. M. Pillai, V. Oldemburgo de Mello, and J. J. Van Bavel. 2025. *Sycophantic AI increases attitude extremity and overconfidence*. Preprint. (2025). https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/vmyek_v3

C. Wu, M. Ye, and P. Park. 2025. "Tied to Place: Geographic Origins of Tie Survival." In: *International Conference on Social Computing, Behavioral-Cultural Modeling and Prediction and Behavior Representation in Modeling and Simulation*. Springer. https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-032-07715-8_5

K. V. Koevering, M. Ye, and J. Kleinberg. 2024. *What's in a Niche? Migration Patterns in Online Communities*. (2024). <https://arxiv.org/abs/2407.11794>

M. Ye, E. Schneiders, R. Lee, and M. Jung. 2023. “The Future of Home Appliances: A Study on the Robotic Toaster as a Domestic Social Robot.” In: *32nd IEEE International Conference on Robot and Human Interactive Communication (RO-MAN)*. <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/10309555>

M. Ye, R. Lee, J. Michalove, and J. Wong. 2023. “Toaster Bot: Designing For Utility and Enjoyability in the Kitchen Space.” In: *Companion of the 2023 ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI '23 Companion)*. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3568294.3580182>

Workshops, Posters, and Presentations

J. Kim, L. Popowski, L. Conwill, E. Li, M. Ye, J. Liu, J. A. Guridi, T. Henderson, B. Han, D. Wang, et al.. 2026. *The Capacity to Care: Designing Social Technology for Sustained Engagement With Societal Challenges*. (2026). <https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.05651>

M. Ye. 2025. “Navigating Context Collapse: How Network Structure and Message Directedness Shape Online Expression.” In: *Companion Publication of the 2025 Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW Companion '25)*. Association for Computing Machinery, 390–393. ISBN: 9798400714801. DOI: 10.1145/3715070.3749258

K. V. Koevering, M. Ye, and J. Kleinberg. 2025. *What’s in a Niche? Migration Patterns in Online Communities*. Poster presented at IC2S2, Norrköping, Sweden. (2025)

K. V. Koevering, A. Young, M. Ye, and J. Kleinberg. 2025. *Freezing and Thawing of Linguistic Binomials*. Poster presented at IC2S2, Norrköping, Sweden. (2025)

Honors & Awards

Sansom Graduate Fellow , Carnegie Mellon University	2025 – 2026
Rawlings Cornell Presidential Research Scholar , Cornell University	2020 – 2023
John McMullen Dean’s Scholar , Cornell University	2020 – 2023
Dean’s List (all semesters) , Cornell University	2020 – 2023

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, Carnegie Mellon University <i>Network Analysis (17-338 / 17-668)</i>	Fall 2024
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Service

Student Advocacy and Mentorship:

AI Research Institute on Interaction for AI Assistants (ARIA) Student Leadership Council	2026–Present
CMU SCS Undergraduate Research Opportunities, Mentor	2024–Present
CMU Graduate Student Association, Societal Computing Student Representative	2024–2026
CMU Software and Societal Systems REU Program, Mentor	2025
CMU Graduate Application Support Program, Mentor	2024, 2025
CMU Software and Societal Systems REU Program, Admissions Committee	2025, 2026
CMU Societal Computing PhD Admissions Committee	2026
CMU Graduate Student Campus Affairs Committee	2026

Research mentees: Aria Lakhmani (CMU Undergraduate), Changyang Wu (CMU Undergraduate), Ngoc Ta (CMU REUSE), Jerry Chen (CMU MS)

Conference Reviewer:

IC2S2	2025
AIES	2026